caravan going to Erzeroum from here just now and we should have had considerable difficulty in getting the mules required. 3rd Mr. Brandt[10] there is very anxious to form a connexion with Persia and my friends here were desirous that I should see him and if possible come to some agreement to that effect. He will most probably go with us to Erzeroum, where he already has an agent, if the trade is ever carried on regularly that must be the point of disembarkation and I was particularly anxious to try that route. 4th. The Plague is over there and I have no fear on that score in fact if you look at the circumstances there is scarcely any reasonable ground for anxiety with regard to these diseases. In the last twenty years in both Turkey and Persia there is no instance of an Englishman having died of either plague or Cholera, two have come to my knowledge to have taken it but both have recovered.[11] If Edward were not with me, I assure you I should go without the slightest hesitation into the most infected places.

C. Hanson has been particularly kind, when you see his brother do not fail to express our sense of his goodness — his charges on the goods have been 1 per cent and he has got us off more than half the Turkish duties therefore by paying him this we are considerably gainers. The flannel we shall be too late for Persia therefore I only take a small quantity on. The remainder is gone to the Sultan and I believe sold at a good profit, but the answer is to come today. Our long passage was a most serious misfortune, as it has thrown us so late in the winter but this promises to be a mild one and I have no doubt of getting on. On my return I have every reason to expect I shall bring silk and C. H^{n}. promises that on my writing to him that I am on my way, he will remit to England £1500 or £2000 — this may be a great accommodation should we be at all late which I trust will not be the case. I think there is a great deal to be done in the Persian silk particularly as it so facilitates the getting off my goods immediately and a quick return. I have drawn upon you for £200 at 61 days after sight which was what he wished and as the date is Decr. 10th it will come due about the time you expected. I could not with prudence make the date longer as this was his desire. I hope you will not be inconvenienced by this. Business here is just now very flat, but from all I can learn of the Persian trade I think better than I ever did of my assortment.

The news from Persia is not good. The plague is in Tabreez but have little doubt but that it will be over by the time we get there. I do not think it im-

10 English consul at Trebizond, cf. letter of Edward Burgess, postscript to the letter of Charles, dated Jan. 17, 1831.

11 This seems quite incredible, in view of the frequent European quarantines and "cordons" in times of plague, cf. especially Charles's letter from Corfu, dated July 23, 1835, referring to a Neapolitan quarantine of continental travellers, due to the outbreak of cholera in Toulon and Nice, and the article in *Revue de l'Orient*, série 1, tome 1, p. 69–87, *Des quarantines; nécessité de les réformer par suite de leur adoption en Angleterre et en Autriche*, by L. Aubert-Roche.

Generated on 2020-09-15 23:21 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112401
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN